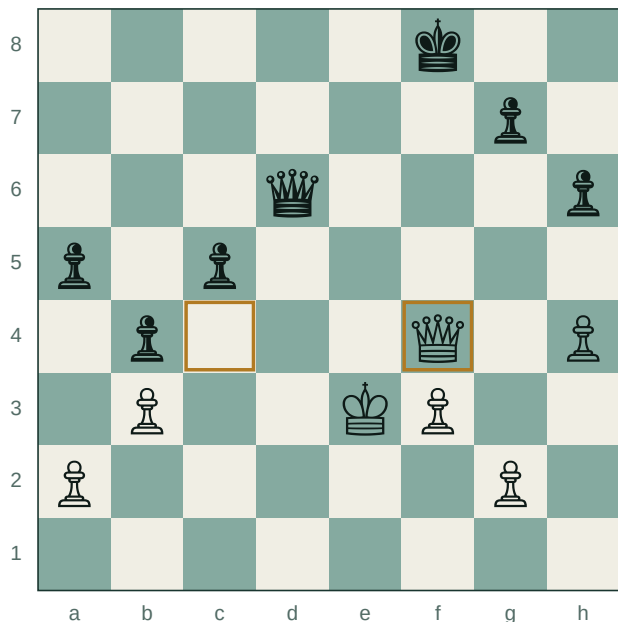


Queen-ending tactics: Black, move 41

Queen-ending tactics

Black to move



Previous move: 41.Qf4+. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

41...Qxf4+ 42. Kxf4 c4 43. Ke4 c3

41...Qxf4+ Check restricts White to 4 legal replies here. The move also takes the queen on f4. Recorded reply: **42.Kxf4**.

42...c4 The pawn moves from c5 to c4. Recorded reply: **43.Ke4**.

43...c3 The pawn moves from c4 to c3.

At the end, nominal material is White 5 / Black 5 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, Black's balance changes by +0. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does Black's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +0: the balance goes from +0 to +0. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

A favorable-looking queen exchange can lead to a drawn pawn ending. Evaluate the new ending before simplifying.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

Queens combine long-range checks with promotion support. King shelter and the order of checks often matter more than a small material lead.

HOW TO LOOK

Inspect perpetual-check possibilities, queen trades, and checks that gain a tempo for a passed pawn.

The defending king is on e3. Look for a defender that can be displaced or overloaded.